

Thank you, Ida, for setting the stage. Now, let's explore the foundations upon which the EU AI Act is built.

Consider the Act as a response to a fundamental question: 'How should AI evolve within our society?' The motivations behind the Act revolve around three central tenets:

Human-Centricity: The EU AI Act puts people at the forefront. It's about ensuring that as AI systems become more integrated into our lives, they support and enhance our human experience rather than undermine it. This principle advocates for AI that upholds our societal values and individual dignities.

Ethical Development: Ethics isn't just a buzzword here; it's a pillar. The EU aims for AI that is developed with a moral compass—a compass that points towards the public good, not just profit margins. The idea is to create AI that we can trust because it's aligned with ethical standards that protect and promote our well-being.

Regulatory and Legal Framework: Harmony is key. The Act intends to weave a consistent legal fabric across Europe to govern AI, preventing a patchwork of rules that could lead to confusion and exploitation. This unified approach aims to foster an environment where AI can be both innovative and safe.

In essence, the EU AI Act isn't just legislation; it's a philosophical statement about the future relationship between humanity and AI. It's about guiding AI development in a way that respects the complexity of human values and the integrity of individual autonomy.

Building upon our motivation for the AI Act, let's examine its implementation, particularly the gradation of risk it introduces. The Act categorizes AI applications into four levels of risk: Minimal Risk, Limited Risk, High Risk, and Unacceptable Risk.

Level 1: Minimal Risk include AI applications like playful chatbots or typical spam filters. These are seen as friendly neighbors in our digital backyard. They're common, generally harmless, and don't require EU intervention. Think of them as the digital equivalent of board games or a letter opener – tools that make life a bit easier or more enjoyable without causing a stir.

Level 2: Limited Risk Moving up, we have applications like Deep Fakes and certain chatbots, which are marked as 'Limited Risk.' Applications in this category hold more potential for concern than the straightforward tools we see in Level 1. Here the key is: transparency. The Act calls for clear labeling – so no one's tricked into thinking a deep fake is real, or mistaking a chatbot for a human. It's like having ingredients listed on your food; you should know what you're consuming, digitally speaking.

Level 3: High Risk Here, we tread into more serious territory. Applications involved in critical sectors like transportation, healthcare, law enforcement – these are tagged as 'High Risk.' The stakes are higher; thus, the Act enforces stringent compliance. AI systems in these fields must be reliable, secure, and respectful of our rights. They should be transparent, excelling in risk assessment, data quality, and provide detailed documentation. We can think of it as the meticulous examination that happens before a car can hit the road.

Level 4: Unacceptable Risk At the top of the risk pyramid, we encounter the 'Unacceptable Risk' zone. Here lies the controversial practice of social scoring by governmental entities—an action strictly prohibited by the Act. Such measures are off the table, showcasing the EU's firm dedication to upholding our core freedoms and the principles of democracy.

But with every rule there come exemptions, for which I am now handing over to my collage Markus.